

Matthias Florian Sahli

Postdoctoral Researcher

Bern University of Applied Sciences, Business School

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SUMMARY

Postdoctoral researcher at the Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH) Business School, previously an economist at the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) of the United Nations and at the Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property — seven years of applied economics outside the university sector; PhD in Economics, University of Neuchâtel (2023). I work on the economics of intellectual property, innovation, digitization and the creative industries, building new datasets and running rigorous econometric analyses to inform policy.

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2024 – present — **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)** · Business School, Bern, Switzerland
Postdoctoral Researcher

EDUCATION

2025 – 2026 — **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)** · Bern, Switzerland
Certificate in Higher Education Teaching (Hochschuldidaktik)

2019 – 2023 — **University of Neuchâtel** · Neuchâtel, Switzerland
PhD in Economics

2016 – 2019 — **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
MSc in Economics

2012 – 2016 — **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
BSc in Economics, minor in Political Sciences

2006 – 2011 — **Gymnasium Hofwil & Schule für Gestaltung Bern** · Münchenbuchsee, Switzerland
Matura; talent promotion class in fine arts

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2019 – 2024 — **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), United Nations** · Department for Economics and Data Analytics, Geneva, Switzerland
Economist and researcher — PhD Research Fellow (2019–2023), then Postdoctoral Research Fellow (2023–2024)

2017 – 2019 — **Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property (IPI)** · Bern, Switzerland
Economist, Office of the Chief Economist — internship (2017–2018), then Junior Economist (2018–2019)

RESEARCH

20	77	4	6
publications & papers	citations	h-index	peer-reviewed venues

Source: Google Scholar, retrieved 2026-11-14.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Digital Reuse and Online Availability of Visual Artworks**
  M. Sahli, A. Cuntz & P. J. Heald · *Information Economics and Policy* · 2026 · 11 citations
- **Does the Digitalization of the Book Industry Reduce Its Environmental Impact?**
  M. Sahli, J. Bieser et al. · *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption* · 2026 · 1 citation

- **Evaluating the Sustainability of National Libraries: A Life Cycle Sustainability Assessment**
  J. Chenoweth, J. Bieser, M. Day, N. Ilott, M Lin, J. Love, M. Martens, R. Murphy, M Nepfer, M. Pennock, U. Pottgiesser, M. Sahli, O. Sievi, and J. Suckling · *Accepted at npj Heritage Science* · 2026
- **Is There a Premium for Legacy Artists? The Death Effect in Exhibition Shows and Auction Transactions**
  M. Sahli & A. Cuntz · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2025 · 4 citations
- **Sustainability in Context: An Evidence-based (Digital) Preservation Lifecycle Investigation**
  M. Pennock, M. Sahli & J. Chenoweth · *iPRES 2025, Wellington* · 2025 · 2 citations
- **Million Dollar Baby — A Primer on Film Finance Practices in the U.S. Movie Industry**
  A. Cuntz, A. Muscarnera, P. C. Oguguo & M. Sahli · *Industry & Innovation* · 2024 · 15 citations
- **Intermediary Liability and Trade in Follow-on Innovation**
  A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2023 · 21 citations

UNDER REVIEW

- **From Digitization to Diffusion: Evidence on the Economic Value of Open Cultural Heritage in the Generative AI** R&R AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
  M. Sahli, J. Bieser, J. Chenoweth, J. Suckling, J. Love, E. Lin, M. Martens, M. Pennock & U. Pottgiesser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Gender Gaps in Museum Exhibitions and Art Auctions: Evidence from Linked Exhibition and Auction Records** UNDER REVIEW AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
  L. J. Noll & M. Sahli · *ACEI Working Paper Series* · 2026 · 3 citations
- **Open by Design: Open Distribution as a Strategic Choice for Cultural Organizations** UNDER REVIEW AT PUBLIC MONEY & MANAGEMENT
  M. Sahli, E. Bertacchini & J. Bieser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Elvis' Ghost or Digital Replica? Publicity Rights and Integrated IP Strategy** SUBMITTED TO
  A. Cuntz, B. Lutes & M. Sahli · *WIPO Economic Working Paper No. 89* · 2025 · 1 citation

TEACHING

2026 –	**HES-SO — Haute École de Gestion Genève** · Economics of Innovation (guest lecturer)
2025 –	**Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH), Business School** · Entrepreneurial Law (Master), lecturer and module coordination ★ 5.5 / 6 · Digitalrecht (Bachelor), lecturer ★ 5.25 / 6 · Data Literacy (continuing education), lecturer · Lecture Series SDG1 (Bachelor), lecturer
2025	**EPFL, College of Management** · MGT-404 Management of Intellectual Property (Master) ★ 1.24 / 4 1 = best possible score
ongoing	**Supervision of Student Theses** · Supervision of bachelor's and master's theses, practice projects and applied R&D projects

GRANTS & AWARDS

2026	Swisscom study — "From Data to Action: Do Digital GHG Management Tools Drive Real-World Emission Reductions?" (CHF 32,409)
2021	Best Paper Award, Young Researchers Workshop, 21st International Conference on Cultural Economics, Lille (USD 500)
2020	Travel grant for the study visit at Copenhagen Business School — Commission de Recherche FNS / Fonds des Donations, University of Neuchâtel

RESEARCH INTERESTS & SKILLS

Interests	Intellectual property · economics of innovation · industrial organization · economic policy · applied econometrics · creative industries · art markets · sustainability · digitization
Languages	Swiss German (native) · German · English · French
Software	Stata · R · Python (basics) · LaTeX · web crawling